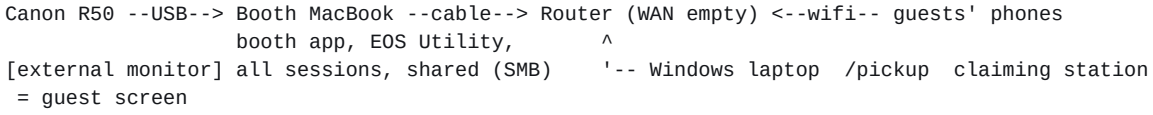
Pickup by number: setup and test flow

MacBook booth with a preview monitor, and the Windows laptop as the claiming station. From the queue to a phone holding four photos, a strip and a video.

The setup	The **MacBook is the booth**: it takes the photos, builds every strip and stores everything. An **external monitor on the Mac** is the guest screen. The **Windows laptop is the claiming station**: it reads the Mac's shared folder and lists each guest by number. No iPad. No internet needed.
What a guest gets	**4 photos, 1 strip and 1 video** (an MP4, which Instagram and Facebook accept), by scanning a QR the operator shows on the Windows laptop.
What you need	MacBook and external monitor, Windows laptop, Canon R50 with USB-C cable and BR-E1, a travel router (WAN port empty), a printed join-wifi sign, and two phones (one iPhone, one Android).
Open risks	EOS Utility for Mac lists macOS 26, 15 and 14: a newer macOS is **unverified** (Test 1). The Mac-to-Windows folder share is untested on real hardware (Tests 4, 13, 14). With 4 photos the frame art is dropped until a 4-window frame exists.

How a guest moves through it

	Where	What happens
1	The queue	A sign with the **join-wifi QR**. They join the booth wifi while they wait.
2	Centre stage	They frame on the camera's own viewfinder and take **4 shots**. The monitor counts down; staff press the BR-E1.
3	The monitor	It shows **their finished strip**. Staff at the Mac press **Accept**, or **Retake this one**.
4	The monitor	A large **number** (1, 2, 3..., restarting each day) and *Tell this number at the claiming station*. The number is also stamped on the strip. **No QR here.**
5	Claiming station	The guest says their number. The operator types it, **hovers** the strip, clicks **Show QR**, and the guest scans it to download everything.



Part 1 · Set up

Tick these in order. Full detail: EVENT-SETUP.md section 1b.

A. The Mac

- [ ] Mains power; display off **Never**; **FileVault on**.
- [ ] `brew install ffmpeg` done, and `ffmpeg -version` prints a version. Without it there is no video.
- [ ] Canon **EOS Utility 3 for macOS** installed (R50 needs 3.16.10+; 3.19.0+ is native on Apple Silicon). This Mac runs macOS: _____ (Canon lists 26, 15, 14; if newer it is unverified).
- [ ] Camera tethered: **Photo Import/Remote Control**, manual exposure and white balance, **JPEG only**, auto power-off off, BR-E1 paired. **Photos / Image Capture closed.** EOS Utility destination folder = the booth's watch folder.
- [ ] Booth app running (`dotnet run --project src/Photobooth.Server`, or the Mac ZIP). Allow incoming connections when asked. `http://localhost:5000/operator` opens.

B. Router

- [ ] Travel router, **WAN port empty**, mode Router, WPA2, **client isolation and guest mode off**.
- [ ] The Mac and the Windows laptop are both on it (cable preferred, with a fixed address).

C. Mac settings

The Settings page is at the foot of the operator rail.

- [ ] **Watch folder** = EOS Utility's destination. **Output folder** is a different folder. **Check**, then **Save**.
- [ ] **Photos per strip: 4.** (The shipped frame has three windows; at 4 the frame art is dropped and you get a plain 4-photo strip.)
- [ ] **Let guests download their photos**: on. Wifi name and password **exactly** as on the router. **Save wifi details**. **Print the join-wifi QR** that appears, for the queue sign.
- [ ] **Hand over by number**: on. **Use a separate claiming station**: off.
- [ ] **Share the Output folder**: System Settings > General > Sharing > File Sharing. Give the Windows laptop's user Read & Write. Mac's address: _____

D. The monitor

- [ ] External monitor connected and set as the **main display** (System Settings > Displays).
- [ ] Run `tools/mac-display.command --local`. It shows *Step in and smile* fullscreen. No iPad, certificate or HTTPS is needed.

E. The Windows laptop (claiming station)

- [ ] Windows build installed and run. Allow `Photobooth.Server` on **Private networks** when asked.
- [ ] Connect to the Mac's share: File Explorer > `\\<Mac address>\<share>`. Sign in as the Mac user, tick **Remember my credentials**, and map it to a drive letter set to **Reconnect at sign-in**. Drive: _____
- [ ] Settings (`http://localhost:5000/diagnostics`): **Output folder** = the shared folder (**Check**, **Save**).
- [ ] **Let guests download their photos** on, the **same wifi name and password**, and **Guests reach the booth at** = this laptop's address on the router.
- [ ] **Serve the display to the network**: on. **This computer is the claiming station only**: on. **Restart the app.**
- [ ] `http://localhost:5000/pickup` opens and shows *Claiming station* in place of the camera status.

Part 2 · The test run

Do these in order. Stop at the first failure and note it.

> **Test 1 can end the Mac plan**
>
> If EOS Utility will not run, or will not see the R50, on this macOS, **stop**: use the Windows laptop as the booth for the event and report the macOS version.

- [ ] **1.** **Camera and EOS Utility on this Mac.** QA-CHECKLIST.md section 0: ten BR-E1 presses over five minutes, each landing a JPEG in the watch folder, camera **Ready**.
- [ ] **2.** **The monitor** counts down with the operator console and shows each shot.
- [ ] **3.** **One full session, 4 shots. Reorder** two shots and **Retake this one**: the strip must change to match. Press **Accept**. The monitor shows a **large number and no QR**. Open `strip.jpg` in the session folder: **No. N** at the foot, the same N.
- [ ] **4.** **The claiming station sees it.** On the Windows laptop, `/pickup` shows that guest with the same number within about 3 seconds. Time: ____ s.
- [ ] **5.** **Find a guest.** Type the number: only that guest remains. **Hover** the strip: **Show QR** appears. Click: a large QR, with the wifi name. **Close** returns to the grid. Clear the box: everyone is back.
- [ ] **6.** **Numbers.** Take three more guests: consecutive numbers. **Restart the Mac's booth app**, take one more: the number carries on, with no repeat.
- [ ] **7.** **Two guests back to back.** Start guest 2 *while guest 1 is still on the claiming station*. Both appear, correctly numbered; guest 1's QR opens guest 1's photos.
- [ ] **8.** **Download on two phones** (iPhone and Android) joined from the queue sign. Show QR to strip visible ____ s; to all photos ____ s. The page offers **4 photos, the strip and the video**. Save a photo and the video; **Download all** gives a zip. Post the video to Instagram and Facebook. A phone **not** on the wifi: the QR fails to open.
- [ ] **9.** **The queue sign:** from a phone not yet on the wifi, scan it. It joins without a password.
- [ ] **10.** **Several phones at once** (5+), all downloading. Note when it slows: _____
- [ ] **11.** **Sizes**: photo-1.jpg _____ thumb-1.jpg _____ strip.jpg _____ strip.mp4 _____
- [ ] **12.** **Security.** From a phone on the guest wifi, `https://<Windows laptop>:5002/api/pickup` and `.../api/sessions` must both show *not found*.
- [ ] **13.** **Shared folder under load.** Take guests quickly on the Mac while watching the Windows grid: every guest appears, none half-loaded (a strip with no photo behind it).
- [ ] **14.** **Mac off.** Quit the booth app on the Mac for a minute: the Windows grid keeps the guests already taken, and their downloads still open while the Mac is on and sharing.
- [ ] **15.** **Restart the Windows app** and reload `/pickup`: the same numbers return.

> **If the Mac cannot be the booth**
>
> The Windows laptop can be the booth as before (EVENT-SETUP.md section 5) with **Hand over by number** on. It is then both booth and claiming station: its own `/pickup` lists its own guests, and no folder share is needed.

What to bring back

- [ ] Pass/fail for each step, the times from steps 4 and 8, and the **macOS version**.
- [ ] Whether EOS Utility ran and tethered the R50 on that macOS, and whether the BR-E1 worked while tethered.
- [ ] How the Windows grid kept up with the Mac over the share: any guest slow to appear, appearing with a missing photo, or any dropped connection.
- [ ] The diagnostics bundle from the Mac (`/diagnostics`) and the version at the foot of the operator rail.
- [ ] Whether the video posted on Instagram and Facebook.
- [ ] Whether the number flow made sense: was the number easy to remember and say, and how long did the operator take to find a guest.
- [ ] Whether the 4-photo strip without the frame is acceptable, or a 4-window frame is needed.

Results

Step	Pass / fail	Notes
1 Camera + EOS Utility		
2 Monitor		
3 Session, number on strip		
4 Windows sees guest		
5 Find + Show QR		
6 Numbers + restart		
7 Back to back		
8 Phones download		
9 Queue sign		
10 Several phones		
11 Sizes		
12 Security		
13 Share under load		
14 Mac off		
15 Windows restart		